

FUNCTIONS OF A SYSTEM ADMIN, IN BRIEF

- User administration (setting up and maintaining account)
- Maintaining the system
- Verifying that peripherals are working properly
- Quickly arranging to repair hardware on the occasion of hardware failure
- Monitoring system performance
- Creating file systems
- Installing software
- Creating a backup and recovery policy
- Monitoring network communication
- Updating system as soon as new version of OS and application software comes out
- Implementing policies for the use of the computer system and network
- Setting up security policies for users. A system admin must have a strong grasp of computer security (e.g. firewalls and intrusion detection systems).

It's their job to anticipate potential issues and come up with contingencies for the same.

On being questioned whether the profile changes from company to company, Syed says. “Yes, the role of the system administrator can change depending on the structure and size of the company. In case of small and medium scale companies, the complete network meaning the servers, network devices such as routers and switches, and their configuration will also be managed by the system administrators.”

“The role of the System Administrator changes with enterprise, mid-range & small companies. There is a specific job in System Admin at the enterprise Level. This is mainly because of volume of the business and the number of employees,” Ramarao added, when asked the same question.

This being said, we should also point out that there has always been a confusion between the job descriptions of system administrators and network administrators. The truth is there isn't any tangible difference between the two jobs.

A system administrator's job is usually broader and not as specialised as that of a network admin; though, admittedly, 'SysAdmin' usually refers to the person who manages the servers. Smaller companies tend to have just system administrators.